

Christoffer Nilsson

I am the kind of person who really loves my job. I spend a lot of my free time programming applications and puzzles just for fun and reading blogs. Apart from my job I like to spend time with my family, my girlfriend who is a teacher and our 5-year-old son and 1-year-old daughter. I also follow a lot of sports for example golf, which I also (try to) play myself, hockey and some football.

It is important to me to have a good relationship with the people I work with. I like to collaborate daily with my colleagues and value team effort more than what I do myself. In teams where I have worked for longer time periods, I have ended up in a role where I handle much of the communication with stakeholders, architects and users. It is something I like since I value having a bigger picture of how my team fits in with the organization.

The project that I am most proud of having been a part of is the one at Thomas Cook. I worked in a very inspiring team and was trusted with a lot of responsibility even though I was the only consultant on the team. The journey we made, from a monolithic .Net application to more of a microservice architecture with modern tech stack and continuous delivery, has shown me what is possible to achieve if you set your mind to it.

Experience

Svenska Spel

2023-08-01 - Ongoing

Scala · .Net · k8s · GCP · GitHub · Argo · GitHub Actions · Testkube · LGTM · Kafka · Kafka Streams · ksqlDB · Adobe Experience Platform · Data Mesh

Svenska Spel is Sweden's state-owned gambling company. The company offers games and betting on the Swedish market and works for a healthy and safe gambling market.

Backend developer martech

For two years, I worked on integrating Svenska Spel's marketing platform, Adobe Experience Platform, focusing on real-time communication and data supply from data products. Svenska Spel uses a Data Mesh strategy to share data. The events included transactions on the order of a few hundred events per second, which made guarantees of data correctness and latency major challenges, while the technology was new to many people in the project. We built real-time aggregates over streaming data with ksqlDB and Kafka Streams. .NET remains the company's main language, while my team used Scala with Kafka Streams where relevant, for example for real-time processing of transactions on top of Kafka. The work also included handling personal data and GDPR. It resulted in a faster setup for new customer communication and the ability to test and measure its impact.

Backend developer pre-study responsible gaming

In parallel with the martech work, I took part in a pre-study for a similar assignment. An event or customer behaviour would trigger an automated action, in this case, for example, identifying excessive gambling and trying to curb it through communication and restrictions. The initial plan was to also use Adobe Experience

Platform for this, but it later became a more custom-built solution in Kafka Streams directly on our Data Mesh.

Tech lead responsible gaming

For the past year, I have worked as a tech lead, a role also titled software architect at Svenska Spel. I am continuing the work carried out during the pre-study, but in a significantly larger team with new internal and external hires. The role involves responsibility for designing the systems the team owns: architecture, planning, stakeholder dialogue, and working out requirements. In my view, the main challenges have been establishing a new team with new systems while we take ownership of existing systems and modernize them as part of Svenska Spel's company-wide programme to move from on-premise to the cloud (GCP). As part of the programme, we move code to GitHub, build with GitHub Actions, and deploy with Argo to Kubernetes. We use Testkube for integration tests and Config Connector (KCC) to configure databases and some permissions. The migration also brings a clearer microservice architecture. We are also responsible for running our services and setting up monitoring and alarms with Grafana and the rest of the LGTM stack.

Memmo.me

2021-08-16 - 2023-06-30

React · React Native · Node.js · GraphQL · Team lead · Payments · CMS/Admin · Real-time messaging · Search · Algolia · Terraform · GCP · Github · Github Actions

Memmo.me is a dynamic and innovative company that operates in the online personalized messaging industry. Memmo.me provides a platform where individuals can connect with their favorite celebrities and influencers to request personalized video greetings, messages, and shoutouts. The company's mission is to create memorable and meaningful experiences for users by bridging the gap between fans and their idols.

Full stack team lead

I joined Memmo.me when the company had just started expanding the IT team and quickly became a team lead for a team focusing on the B2C product and conversion. As a team lead I worked closely with a product owner and was responsible for planning the work for the team. Planning with stakeholders and providing estimates. Coaching the team members and helping them grow. Since the company was still a small one I worked with almost everything in our code base. A react-native app, customer built CMS/Admin tool, payments and payouts, invoicing, real time messaging, integrating a customer support service and a search service and many other things.

Global Connect/IP-Only - Digitization

2018-12-01 - 2021-08-16

Java · Spring Boot · Docker Swarm · .Net · C# · Octopus · Gitlab · Teamcity · MariaDB · MS SQL · Kibana · Elasticsearch · Grafana · AngularJS · TypeScript · Nginx · ArchiMate · Archi · RabbitMQ · IntelliJ · DataGrip · Jira · Jest · Python · PyCharm · JUnit

Global Connect/IP-Only builds and operates one of Sweden's largest and neutral fiber networks. Their business model is to empower digitization by owning, developing and offering the best infrastructure and low level services for the digital society.

The focus of the project was to develop both customer facing and internal it-systems. Before the project started, different parts of the company worked mostly in their own defined processes and tools. The tools could be bought systems but mostly excel and email was used to handle sales and deliveries. The aim was to document all core processes through the different parts of the company and set up integrations and build new systems to make the work faster, easier and less error prone.

System developer .NET

I started the project as a backend .Net developer working with business sales support. IP-Only had just merged with another company called DGC and had inherited some .Net systems for searching connectivity options for addresses and some tools used for deliveries in the Network acquired from DGC. The main issues with this project were that these systems were in bad shape and lacked documentation. Quickly after starting the project I lifted the issues and proposed building new requirements in the IP-Only stack and develop a new module in the legacy system to benefit from everything done in the IP-Only tech stack. This finally led to so much of the functionality already being in the IP-Only stack that we decided to build the UI and missing logic there as well and deprecate the old system. The value gained from this was a more reliable system and now the entire IT development department have the competence needed to fix bugs and monitor the system instead of having a single person responsible for all of this like before.

Full stack developer Java/AngularJS

As the project progressed the role became more and more a Java/AngularJS fullstack developer continuing to build a customer portal. The goal of this was to have enterprise customers log in by themselves and search for network options for their locations. We built this new customer facing feature upon the engine for search described in the previous role. It has an angular frontend for managing addresses, products and so on. We integrated this system with a new self developed product catalog and a back-office UI to manage all products. The integration led to a faster way for customers to get quotes, often automatic replies, on buying new products.

Full stack developer Java/AngularJS

When the first version of the customer portal was released I felt that I wanted to try something new and as a result the Client agreed to move me from the sales support team to the operational support team. There I started working in a developing team with a lot of work dependent on just one team member. I worked close together with the project manager to develop a working development process and implement most of the scrum model. This new role had a few different goals, set up a back-office application for reserving and finding network identifiers of different forms. Providing data for a new Service Now integration as well as setting up APIs to fetch data from Service Now APIs. The other prioritized goal was unifying the stack used to monitor the 2 recently merged networks. This meant merging data sources, set up new services to handle both networks and so on. What I take away from this role is more of the soft skills I developed. Coaching new team-members. Introducing to stakeholders what a sprint demo is and doing a lot of them and so on.

Netlight

2014-10-15 - 2021-08-16

Netlight is a consultant company with about 1400 employees around Europe. It is a company that organically grows and has recruitment as a core function. Netlight values the individual and is organized as a network rather than being hierarchical.

During my years at Netlight I have grown with the company values. We have always had a lot of focus on coaching which I now see in myself as I work at my clients. Working in a team is something that is really important to me and I always strive to help my team mates to develop and enable them to fulfill their goals.

Thomas Cook NE - Responsive website redesign

2015-01-01 - 2018-06-30

React · Node · Redux · Redux-saga · Express · GraphQL · Apollo-client · Apollo-server · Jenkins · Drone · Kibana · Elasticsearch · MS SQL · Redis · RabbitMQ · TFS · .Net · C# · Github · Visual Studio · Enzyme · Mocha · Selenium

Thomas Cook Group is one of the world's largest organizers of charter trips. The group includes i.a. the tour operators Ving, Spies, Tjäreborg, Globetrotter, the airline Thomas Cook Airlines Scandinavia and the hotel chain Sunwing Family Resorts. Thomas Cook Group has 22,000 employees in 15 countries, 20 million customers and a turnover of almost SEK 90 billion.

Thomas Cook Northern Europe wanted reinforcement for their project group that worked on redesigning Ving.se, Ving.no, Spies and Tjäreborg to make the website more mobile-friendly. They wanted to make it responsive, more user-friendly and easier to understand for the convenience of their users.

Full stack developer

I was originally intended to be a back-end .Net developer but I joined a team that had just built a Node.JS API with a AngularJS front-end. Before starting their next project I compared the new angular version and React. To do this I tried building a small application in both frameworks and talking to my Netlight colleges at SVT who had used React for a while. I proposed to switch to React which we ended up doing and it worked out great. I still feel that I like working in React better than Angular even with the newer versions. We then continued to build smaller services for their webpage using Node/Express API:s and React front-end apps.

Workshop leader

When we had started to build more of the React applications for our external web site. We started to notice the need for a component library and common styles to use in our applications. I started pushing for us taking after e.g. Airbnb and make a style guide with components that can be reused and to publish all of these both as a npm package and as a webpage with examples and code snippets. A college and I decided to boot strap this with a workshop for all teams working on the web. We set up a basic repository, had a short introduction, divided up groups with people from different teams and assigned them with building one component each and also an example page where they could be used. They then spread out and started working from their own ideas and we as workshop leaders moved around to each groups and checked if anyone needed help or input from us. The package was well received in all teams and every developer was included in an early stage in creating the package and components. It was important to us that all web developers where comfortable making changes and adding new components in the library since it would otherwise become more of an obstacle than a helpful tool. When I left thomas cook this project was still going strong and had a large impact on the pace new applications could be developed and still keep a coherent ui.

Full stack developer GraphQL

I was trusted with more and more responsibilities at Thomas Cook and when a colleague and me started to discuss the potential of setting up a GraphQL API for the web we got an ok to test it out on a small application. The reason to try it was that we had seen that there was much time going in to writing API:s for similar data again and again across the company e.g. text data from our CMS and facts for hotels. We also had a need to figure out how to handle caching for our API:s to make our API calls run faster when possible.

We started of as a team of three who worked on this and we started to set up our own framework for fetching data from different sources such as cache, API:s and databases. This was not available out of the box in Apollo server at the time we built it, which it to a large portion is today. We set up our first version of caching using an MS SQL in memory database as a key value store. We wanted to use Redis but there was some hosting issues needing sorting out before hand. We therefore used our SQL database in the same way as we would use Redis and use the same kind of methods available on Redis to make it easier to swap them out later. Towards the end of the project we also got access to a Redis instance and could make the switch.

The new API made using data provided by services built in other teams easier as well as providing us with useful data on response times for different types of data. We also tried setting up Apollo client directly on top of React but found it was not easy to build the same functionality that we were used to build using redux and redux-saga. So we ended up just using it in our data access layer at the client and keeping our shared application data in redux as it was previously done.

Belivia - E-health

2014-11-01 - 2014-12-31

.Net · Entity Framework · javascript · MVC · TFS · Azure · BankId · Visual Studio

Belivia is a company working on risk assessment for insurance companies. Part of their product is an electronic health declaration. The health declaration can be tailored to fit the need for different insurance policies by uploading scripts using their own format and the dynamically render the questionnaire to the user.

Upon selling their solution for health declarations to a large swedish insurance company they had to increase security on their application. Data had to be encrypted on disk and participants had to be able to sign their forms using BankId. They therefore decided to rewrite their application in .Net instead of the current PHP.

System developer .Net

I was one of two developers on the project and worked on all parts of the new application. What I learned during this short project was how to integrate with the BankId API, how to handle encryption with rotating keys in the data access layer and how to go through a external security audit.

Kemikalieinspektionen

2013-04-01 - 2013-09-30

Bootstrap · Less · Knockout · .Net · MVC · MS SQL · Entity Framework · Microsoft Visual Studio · Microsoft SQL Management Studio · Subversion

Kemikalieinspektionen is a government agency responsible for monitoring companies that manufacture and import chemical products. Its main mission is to protect people and the environment from hazardous substances. Kemikalieinspektionen has around 250 employees across Sweden.

To make its work more efficient and modernize its database, Kemikalieinspektionen developed a new internal web application for managing substances, products and decisions. I was responsible for implementing functionality to maintain the system's master data. Master data is the foundational data for the rest of the system, such as countries and roles. The system was sensitive to changes in this data, so only administrators were allowed to make changes and every change had to be logged. For logging, we used Self tracking entities, objects that track any changes themselves. This resulted in a logging implementation that was easy to extend to new components later in the project.

System developer

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Scania

2012-04-01 - 2012-09-30

.Net · Windows Forms · Microsoft Visual Studio

Scania is an international company that designs and manufactures trucks. Scania also develops software that controls, for example, the gearbox and engine to reduce fuel consumption in its vehicles by removing the human factor from driving. As more and more of a vehicle is controlled by software, it is important to be able to test it effectively.

To do this, sensor values and control signals in the vehicles are logged, for example gear, speed and road gradient. Domain experts then analyse these signals by plotting different signals in parallel, making it possible to identify faults. To perform this analysis, Scania developed its own .Net application that can plot data logged in real time in the vehicle.

System developer

During my time at Scania, I was responsible for further developing this application so it could open and analyse historical data, support analysing more signals at once, and make it easy to choose which signals are visible in the plot.

The result was an application that could read and handle large volumes of data, as well as a function for searching for events in signals, for example finding all gear changes.

Scania Infomate

2011-04-01 - 2011-09-30

.Net · ASP.NET · C# · Javascript · jQuery · MS SQL · Microsoft Visual Studio

Scania Infomate is a Swedish company owned by Scania that provides and maintains IT solutions, with Scania as its customer.

It is important that the collaboration between Scania Infomate and Scania works as well as possible. Scania Infomate therefore wanted to develop its own tool for creating, distributing and analysing survey results, making it quick and easy to find out what customers and users within Scania think about delivered products.

During my time at Infomate, I was responsible for creating this survey tool. I worked as the sole developer on the project and was responsible for requirements, architecture and implementation. The tool was completely independent of other tools at Scania, with the exception of AD login.

The result was a web application written in C# .Net and ASPX, with an administrator interface, an interface for survey owners and a user interface where authorized users could participate in surveys.

System developer

Education

Royal institute of technology - Master of science program for Computer science

2008-09-01 - 2014-09-01

Technical University of Munich - Exchange semester, computer science program

2013-09-01 - 2013-12-20

Amf1 Berga - Military service, combat boat driver

2009-09-01 - 2010-06-20